EXCELERATE 2026 INTERNSHIP

Week 4: Final Presentation & Reflection Package

DePaul University International Applications Analysis

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The Journey: Weeks 1–3 at a Glance

01

Data Cleaning

Excel: Power Query

- 7,543 records cleaned
- Phone format errors fixed
- Status categories standardized
- Helper columns created

02

Visualization Report

Excel

- Before/after charts
- Missing value analysis
- Country & program distributions
- 8 cleaning actions documented

03

Interactive Dashboard

Power BI

- Single-page narrative design
- 4 KPI cards + 4 charts
- The Outreach Gap story
- 3 actionable recommendations

The Dataset

DePaul University International Graduate Applications — Slate CRM Export

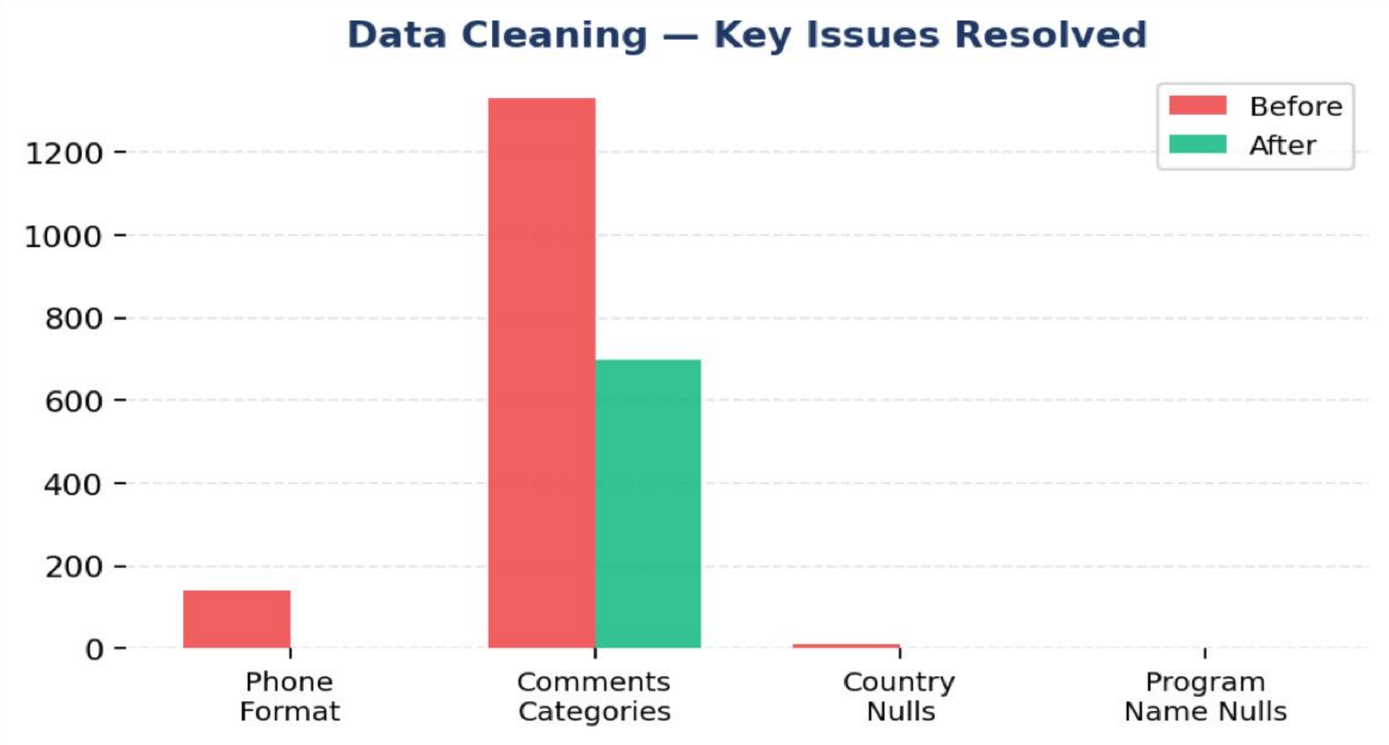
7,543	95	153	39
Total Applications	Countries Represented	Programs Available	Columns in Raw Dataset

Key fields used: Reference_ID, Country, Program_Name, Semester, Year, Comments (status), Outcome_1 (call log), Admit_Date, Phone_Number

Raw data issues: phone numbers in scientific notation, 1,332 inconsistent status categories, missing program names, year anomalies, "N/A" text vs true blanks

Week 1: Data Cleaning

Excel + Power Query



✅ **141 phone numbers**

Fixed scientific notation (e.g. 9.17E+11 → full number)

✅ **1,332 → 700 status categories**

Standardized casing, merged synonyms, extracted final status from multi-line entries

✅ **10 country nulls + 3 program nulls**

Filled via .str.title() and regex extraction from Intake field

⚠️ **"N/A" text ≠ blank**

Outcome_1 used literal "N/A" had to adjust all DAX filters accordingly

Week 2: Visualization Report

Documenting the cleaning impact with before/after charts and distribution analysis

Missing Values Before vs After

Visualized which fields still have gaps (Admit Date: 34.9%, Call Log: 63.9%) vs what was fully resolved

Status Category Consolidation

Showed the reduction from 1,332 to 700 categories the cleaning wasn't just formatting, it changed what was countable

Country & Program Distributions

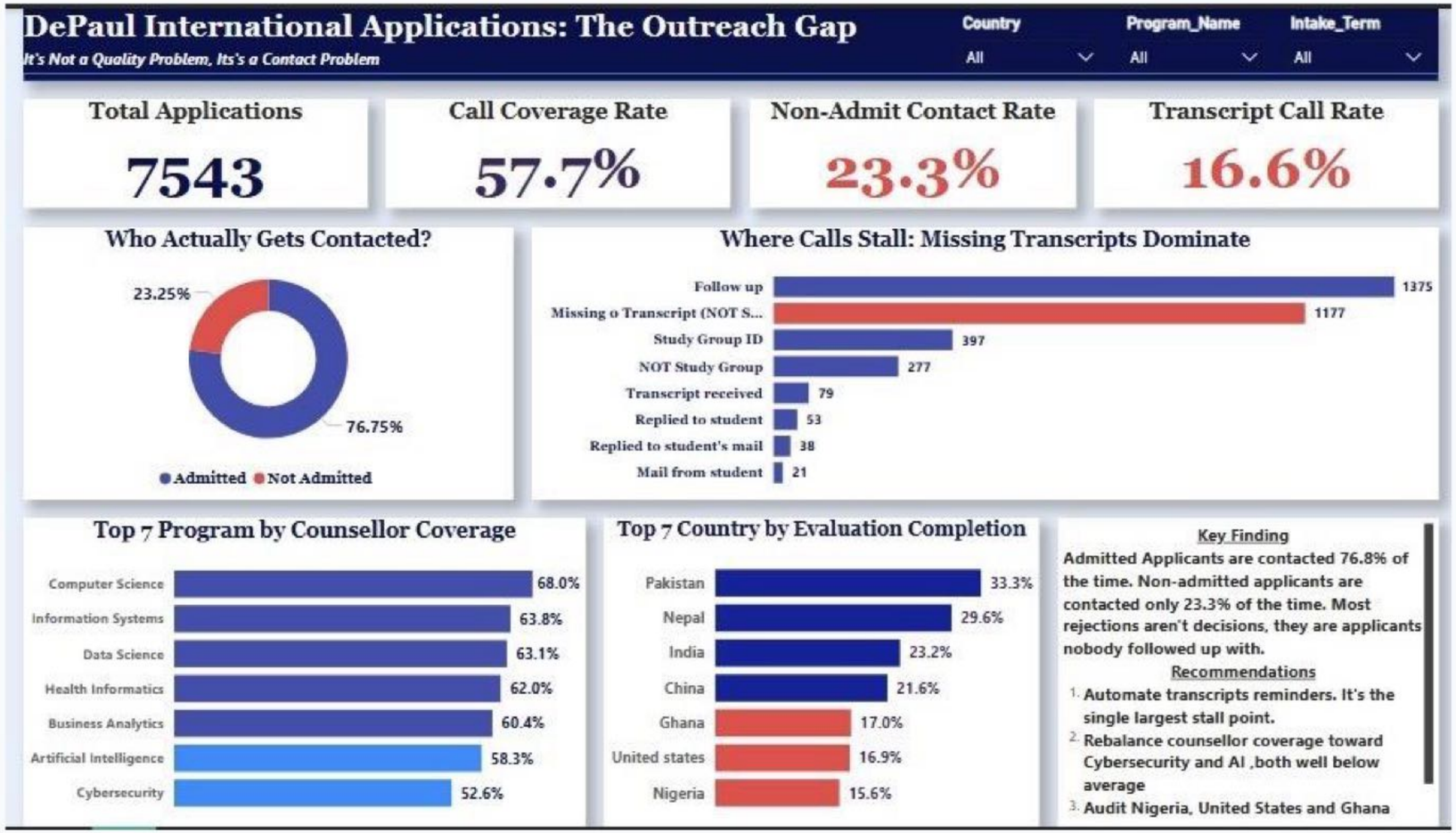
India: 53.7% of apps. Business Analytics + Computer Science: 26% combined. Useful baselines for the dashboard

Year Anomaly Flagging

2022 (1 record) and 2026 (41 records) flagged as Year_Flag = 'Anomaly' rather than deleted audit trail preserved

Week 3: Interactive Dashboard

Power BI single-page, one narrative argument



Design choice

One page, not three, forced prioritisation of what actually mattered

4 KPI cards

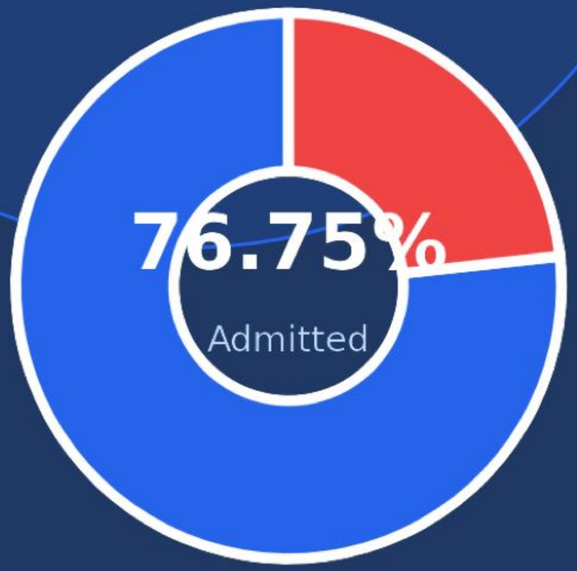
57.7% coverage, 23.3% non-admit contact, 16.6% transcript stall rate

Slicers

Country, Program, Intake Term all cross-filter simultaneously

The Core Finding

It's Not a Quality Problem; It's a Contact Problem



76.75%

of admitted applicants were contacted

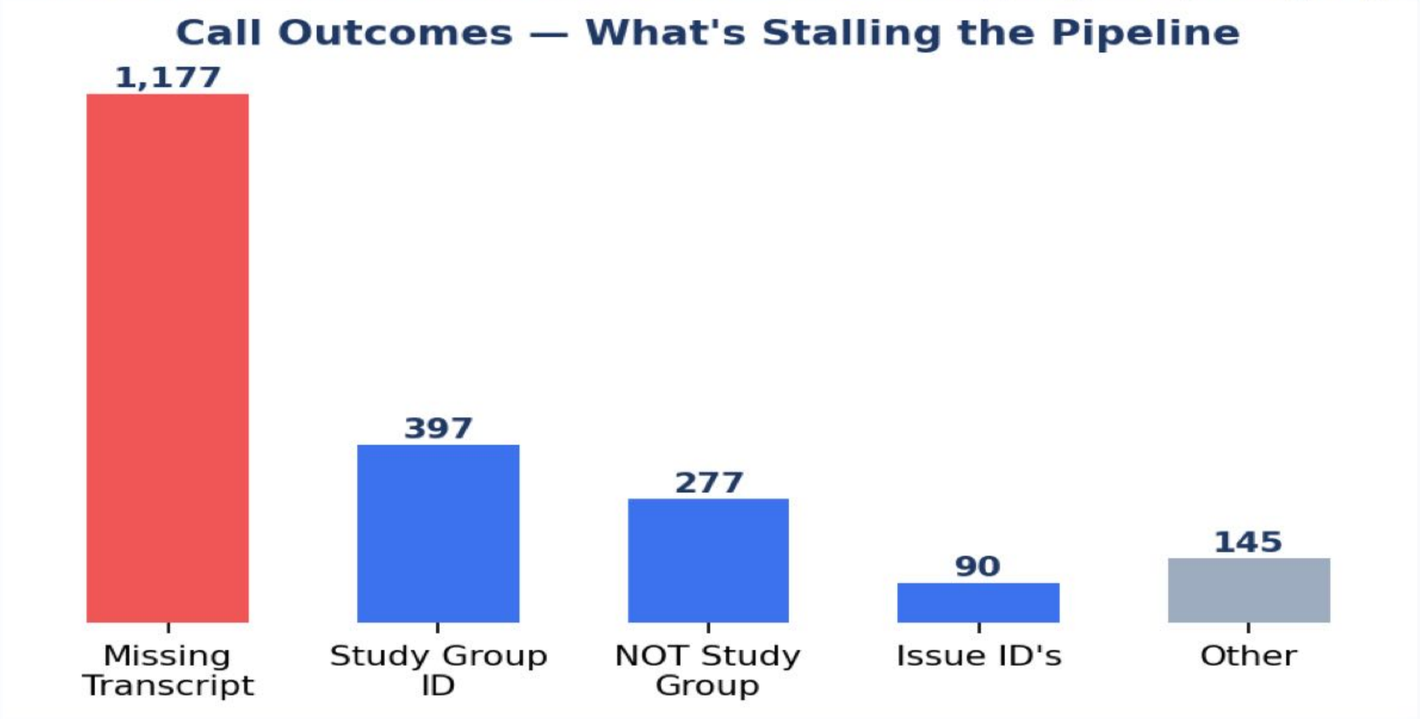
23.25%

of non-admitted applicants were contacted

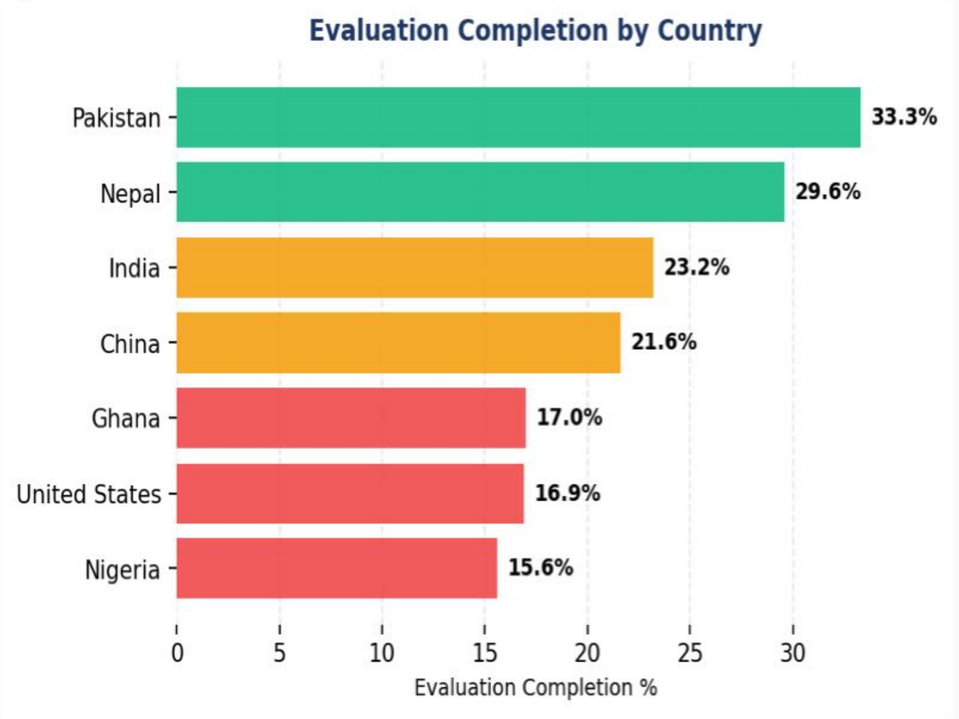
Most rejections aren't decisions, they're applicants who were never followed up with.

What's Driving the Gap?

Three root causes identified across call outcomes, programs, and geography



Root Cause 1: Missing transcripts dominate call outcomes at 53%



Root Cause 3: Nigeria, Ghana, US all under 17% evaluation completion

Root Cause 2 Program coverage gap: Cybersecurity (52.6%) and Artificial Intelligence (58.3%) consistently trail Computer Science (68%) and Information Systems (63.8%) despite comparable application volumes

Recommendations

Three actions, in order of impact

1

Automate Transcript Reminders

53% of logged calls are stalled on missing transcripts. A trigger at the point of application submission before the manual calling campaign even starts would clear the largest single bottleneck without requiring staff to make additional calls.

HIGH

2

Rebalance Counselor Coverage

Cybersecurity and AI applicants are receiving 10–15% less outreach than comparable programs. This doesn't appear to be driven by lower application quality it reads as an assignment or staffing gap. Set a minimum coverage floor per program (recommended: 60%).

MEDIUM

3

Audit Nigeria, Ghana & US Pipelines

All three sit below 17% evaluation completion, despite very different logistical contexts. The US inclusion in particular suggests the cause isn't geography but something specific to how these three pipelines are managed internally. Worth a dedicated process review.

MEDIUM

Reflection & Takeaways

What this internship actually taught me

📊 Data rarely speaks for itself

The cleaning work in Week 1 looked small on paper, 141 phone numbers, a few nulls. But getting those right was the difference between a measure that works and one that silently returns the wrong number.

🔍 The interesting insight is usually in the gap

I built this whole dashboard around what wasn't in the data calls that weren't logged, applicants who weren't contacted. The absence of data told a more useful story than the data itself.

⚙️ Tool fluency is only part of it

Power BI, DAX, Excel I got faster at all of them over four weeks. But the harder skill was deciding which chart to build and why. That's the part you can't look up.

🤝 Real work has friction

Column names don't match. "N/A" isn't blank. The table is called 'Cleaned Data' not 'Cleaned_Applications.' Handling that without breaking everything is the actual job.